

MODULE 08 · DOMAIN 1 - AI & ML FUNDAMENTALS

The Amazon Q Family

Four assistants sharing one letter — and the 2026 reshuffle behind them.

DOMAIN 1 and 3 EXAM WEIGHT mixed MODULE 8 of 14

Amazon Q is **a brand, not a product**. Each Q is a different assistant built into a different service.

Four products, four users

PRODUCT	WHO IT IS FOR, AND WHAT IT DOES
Q Business	Employees. Answers questions from connected company data, with citations.
Q Developer	Engineers. Writes, explains and reviews code; helps in the AWS console.
Q in QuickSight	Analysts. Ask a dashboard questions in plain English, build visuals.
Q in Connect	Contact centre agents. Real-time suggestions during a live call.

ON THE EXAM

Identify the user in the scenario and the product follows. Employee, engineer, analyst, or agent on a call.

An assistant over your company's own data

- ◆ Connects to **S3, SharePoint, Salesforce, Confluence, Slack, ServiceNow** and many more.
- ◆ Indexes that content, then answers questions from it with **citations**.
- ◆ **Permission-aware**. Users only get answers from documents they may already open.
- ◆ **Q Apps** let non-developers build small guided assistants from a description.
- ◆ It is a finished product, not a platform. You configure it; you do not build on it.

ON THE EXAM

Q Business is managed RAG with connectors and a user interface already attached. That framing answers most questions about it.

Q Business or build on Bedrock?

AMAZON Q BUSINESS

Buy the finished thing

- Connectors, index and UI already built
- Live in days, not months
- Permissions handled for you
- Little control over prompts or models
- Priced per user

BEDROCK

Build exactly what you need

- You choose the model and write the prompts
- Custom interface and custom logic
- You build retrieval and access control
- Engineering effort and ongoing ownership
- Priced per token

THE TIEBREAKER

'Least development effort' or 'no engineering team' points at Q Business. 'Custom workflow' or 'specific model' points at Bedrock.

The assistant for engineers

- ◆ Code completion, generation and explanation inside the IDE.
- ◆ Was **Amazon CodeWhisperer** before the rename. Older material uses that name.
- ◆ Answers AWS questions in the console, and helps diagnose service errors.
- ◆ Agentic features: implement a feature, write tests, review code, upgrade dependencies.
- ◆ Also absorbed **AWS Chatbot**, so it appears in Slack and Teams operations channels.

ON THE EXAM

CodeWhisperer and Q Developer are the same lineage. If a question offers both, it is testing whether you know they merged.

Q in QuickSight and Q in Connect

- ◆ **Q in QuickSight** — ask a dashboard a question in plain English, get a visual back.
- ◆ Also writes executive summaries of what a dashboard is showing.
- ◆ **Q in Connect** — listens to a live call and suggests responses and actions to the agent.
- ◆ Draws those suggestions from your knowledge articles in real time.
- ◆ Both are features inside a host service, not standalone products.

ON THE EXAM

Business users asking questions of data means QuickSight. A human agent being helped mid-call means Connect.

Why permission-awareness matters

- ◆ Q Business integrates with **IAM Identity Center** to know who each user is.
- ◆ Retrieval is filtered by that identity, so answers never cross a permission boundary.
- ◆ Build it yourself on Bedrock and **you** must rebuild this. It is not automatic.
- ◆ This is the same trap we met in Module 6: indexing flattens access control.

ON THE EXAM

Permission-aware retrieval is a genuine reason to choose Q Business over building. It is the part teams underestimate.

The June 2026 clear-out

- ◆ On **30 June 2026** AWS moved around twenty services and features into maintenance.
- ◆ **Amazon Kendra** — closed to new customers 30 July 2026. Successor: Bedrock Knowledge Bases.
- ◆ **Bedrock Agents** became Agents Classic, closed 30 July 2026. Successor: AgentCore.
- ◆ **Amazon Q Business** — closed to new customers 31 July 2026. Successor: Amazon Quick.
- ◆ All three still appear as correct answers in current exam questions.

ON THE EXAM

This is the single largest gap between what the exam tests and what AWS currently sells. Learn the closed services; answer from the catalogue.

What replaced what

- ◆ **Amazon Quick** — an agentic workspace. QuickSight was renamed Quick Suite, then Quick.
- ◆ It absorbs Q Business and adds modules, flows and integrations across many tools.
- ◆ **Kiro** — the direction AWS now points developers, replacing Q Developer.
- ◆ **Bedrock Knowledge Bases** — the replacement for Kendra's enterprise search role.
- ◆ None of these successors appear in the current AIF-C01 question bank.

ON THE EXAM

Knowing the successors stops you being confused by AWS documentation. It does not change a single exam answer.

Carry these into the exam

- ◆ Identify the user. Employee, engineer, analyst, or call-centre agent.
- ◆ 'Least development effort' with company data means Q Business, not Bedrock.
- ◆ Q Developer was CodeWhisperer. Same lineage, renamed.
- ◆ Live call assistance means Q in Connect. Dashboard questions mean Q in QuickSight.
- ◆ Q Business is permission-aware by default. Build it yourself and you own that problem.
- ◆ Kendra, Bedrock Agents and Q Business are all closed to new customers — and all still examinable.

A manufacturer wants employees to ask questions across its SharePoint, Confluence and Salesforce content and get cited answers.

It has no machine learning engineers, wants to launch within weeks, and needs answers restricted to what each employee may already access.

What should the company use?

- ☐ A Build a RAG application on Bedrock
- ☐ B Amazon Q Business
- ☐ C Fine-tune a foundation model on the content
- ☐ D Amazon Q Developer

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the company use?

- A

 Build RAG on Bedrock
Would work, but needs engineers and rebuilding permissions.
- B

 Amazon Q Business
Connectors, citations and permission-aware retrieval, ready-made.
- C

 Fine-tune on the content
A knowledge problem, and fine-tuning ignores permissions entirely.
- D

 Amazon Q Developer
For engineers writing code. Wrong user entirely.

ON THE EXAM

Three constraints all point the same way: no ML engineers, weeks not months, and per-user permissions.

A telecoms contact centre wants to help agents while they are on calls. As the customer describes a problem, the agent should see suggested responses and relevant knowledge articles.

The suggestions must appear during the call, not afterwards.

Which service fits?

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ A Amazon Q in QuickSight | ☐ B Amazon Q Business |
| ☐ C Amazon Q in Connect | ☐ D Amazon Transcribe with Comprehend |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which service fits?

- A

 Q in QuickSight
Dashboards and analytics. No live call involvement.
- B

 Q Business
Employees searching documents. Not real-time call assistance.
- C

 Q in Connect
Built for live agent assist inside the contact centre.
- D

 Transcribe plus Comprehend
Would analyse the call. Suggests nothing to the agent.

ON THE EXAM

'During the call, not afterwards' is the deciding phrase. It rules out every option that works on recordings.

A finance team uses QuickSight dashboards. Analysts want to ask questions like 'why did margin fall in the northern region last quarter' and get a chart back, without filing a request with the BI team.

They are not technical users.

What should be enabled?

- ☐ A Amazon Q in QuickSight
- ☐ B Amazon Q Business
- ☐ C A Bedrock agent over the data warehouse
- ☐ D Amazon Q Developer

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should be enabled?

- A

 Q in QuickSight
Natural language questions against dashboards they already use.
- B

 Q Business
Answers from documents, not from dashboard data.
- C

 Bedrock agent
Engineering effort for non-technical users, duplicating a feature.
- D

 Q Developer
For engineers. These are finance analysts.

ON THE EXAM

The users are already in QuickSight. Enabling a feature in the tool they use beats building anything new.

An engineering manager reads that Amazon Q Business closed to new customers in July 2026, and that Kendra did the same.

She is preparing her team for the AI Practitioner exam and asks whether they should skip both topics.

What is the correct guidance?

- ☐ A Skip them; they are no longer sold
- ☐ B Study them; closed services remain examinable
- ☐ C Study only the successors, Quick and Bedrock Knowledge Bases
- ☐ D Skip Kendra but study Q Business

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct guidance?

- ☐ A Skip them
Both appear as correct answers in current questions.
- ☒ B Study them
Question banks lag service changes, often by years.
- ☐ C Only the successors
Quick and AgentCore are not in the current question bank at all.
- ☐ D Skip Kendra only
No basis for splitting them. Both closed in the same announcement.

ON THE EXAM

Certification content trails the service catalogue. Study what the exam guide lists, and treat availability news as professional context.